



THREAT ADVISORY

**ACTOR
REPORT**

Indian Government targeted by APT-36

Date of Publication

November 4, 2022

Admiralty code

A1

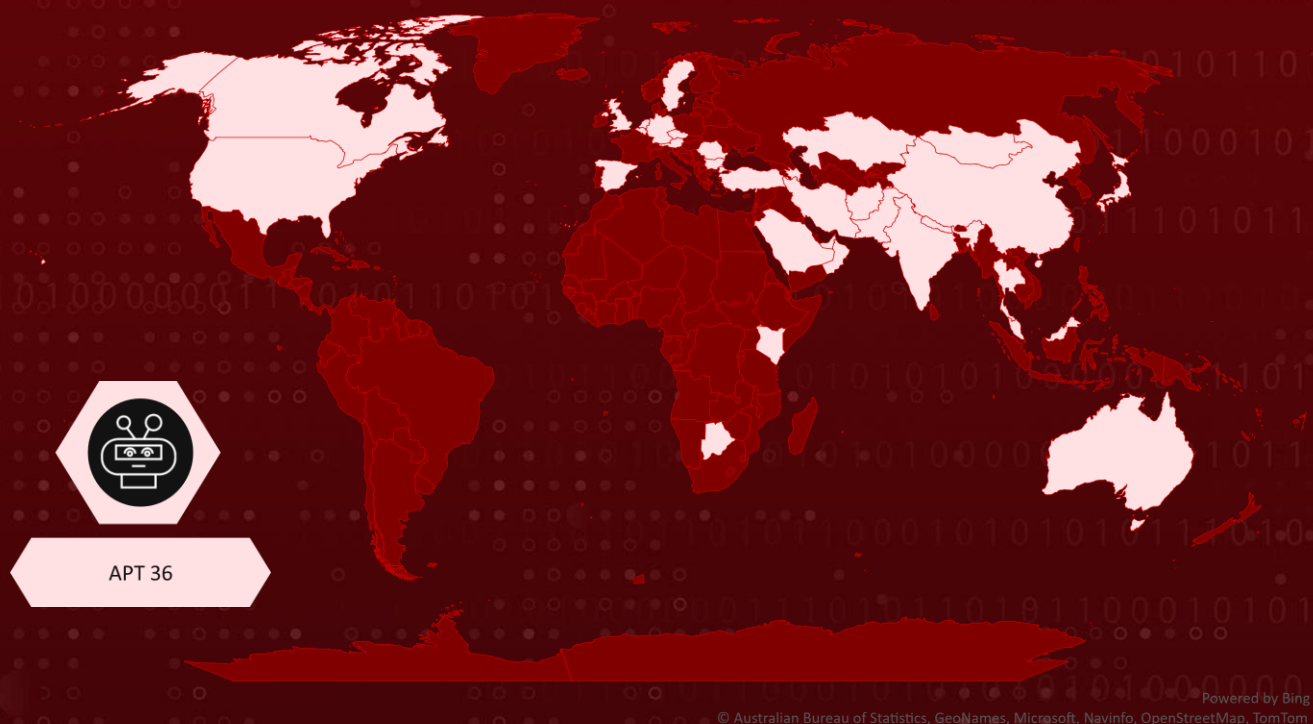
TA Number

TA2022245

Summary

APT 36, also known as Transparent Tribe, is an information theft and espionage gang that was last active in mid-July 2022. Recently, invasive advertising and the data exfiltration tool LimePad were used to target the government sector, specifically in India.

Actor Map



Potential MITRE ATT&CK TTPs

<u>TA0043</u> Reconnaissance	<u>TA0042</u> Resource Development	<u>TA0001</u> Initial Access	<u>TA0009</u> Collection
<u>TA0011</u> Command and Control	<u>TA0010</u> Exfiltration	<u>T1589</u> Gather Victim Identity Information	<u>T1583</u> Acquire Infrastructure
<u>T1583.001</u> Domains	<u>T1566</u> Phishing	<u>T1113</u> Screen Capture	<u>T1105</u> Ingress Tool Transfer
<u>T1041</u> Exfiltration Over C2 Channel			

Technical Details

#1

To entice Indian government users, the APT-36 group attack flow harnessed malvertising via the creation of multiple new domains hosting web pages with fake .NET binary installers posing as the official Kavach app download platform.

#2

This APT group employs LimePad, a novel data exfiltration tool. It comes in the form of a Python-based application bundled inside a VHDX file. The second-stage payload is a Python script that has been built into an executable by PyInstaller. The python script then executes the loader binary, which finally runs the backdoor and begins exfiltrating system data, including snapshots.



Actor Detail

NAME	ORIGIN	TARGET COUNTRIES	TARGET INDUSTRIES
APT 36(Transparent Tribe, ProjectM, Mythic Leopard, TEMP.Lapis, Copper Fieldstone, Earth Karkaddan, C-Major)	Pakistan	Afghanistan, Australia, Austria, Azerbaijan, Belgium, Botswana, Bulgaria, Canada, China, Czech, Germany, India, Iran, Japan, Kazakhstan, Kenya, Malaysia, Mongolia, Nepal, Netherlands, Oman, Pakistan, Romania, Saudi Arabia, Spain, Sweden, Thailand, Turkey, UAE, UK, USA.	Defense, Education, Government, Embassies and Research Organizations
	MOTIVE		
	Information theft and espionage		



Indicator of Compromise (IOC)

TYPE	VALUE
MD5	123b180ed44531bfbac27c6eb0bbe01d,3817590cf8bec4a768bb84405590272f,0ed6451ffe34217e44355706f4900ecc,94daa776792429d1cb65edc1d525e2fc,c195d6bb06c93b94d39e5c1a2dfc6792,889c5c98e88c4889220617f57f5480f7,ac3f2c8563846134bb42cb050813eac8

TYPE	VALUE
URLs	<hxxps: hxxps="" kavach.mail.nic-updates[.]in="" mfid="" securelogin_showsecurelogin.action#!<=""> <hxxps: hxxps="" kavach.mail.gov[.]in="" mfid="" securelogin_showsecurelogin.action#!<=""> <hxxps: <="" hxxps="" kavach.mail.nic-updates[.]in="" mfid="" securelogin_showsecurelogin.action="" web=""> <hxxp: 139.59.23[.]88="" confirmation_id.pdf<="" hxxp=""> <hxxps: details.pdf<="" hxxps="" ncloudup[.]com="" trendmic=""> <hxxp: hxxp="" resultupdate.jpg<="" wzxdao[.]com=""> http://139.59.79[.]86/Pictures.jpg </hxxp:></hxxps:></hxxp:></hxxps:></hxxps:></hxxps:>
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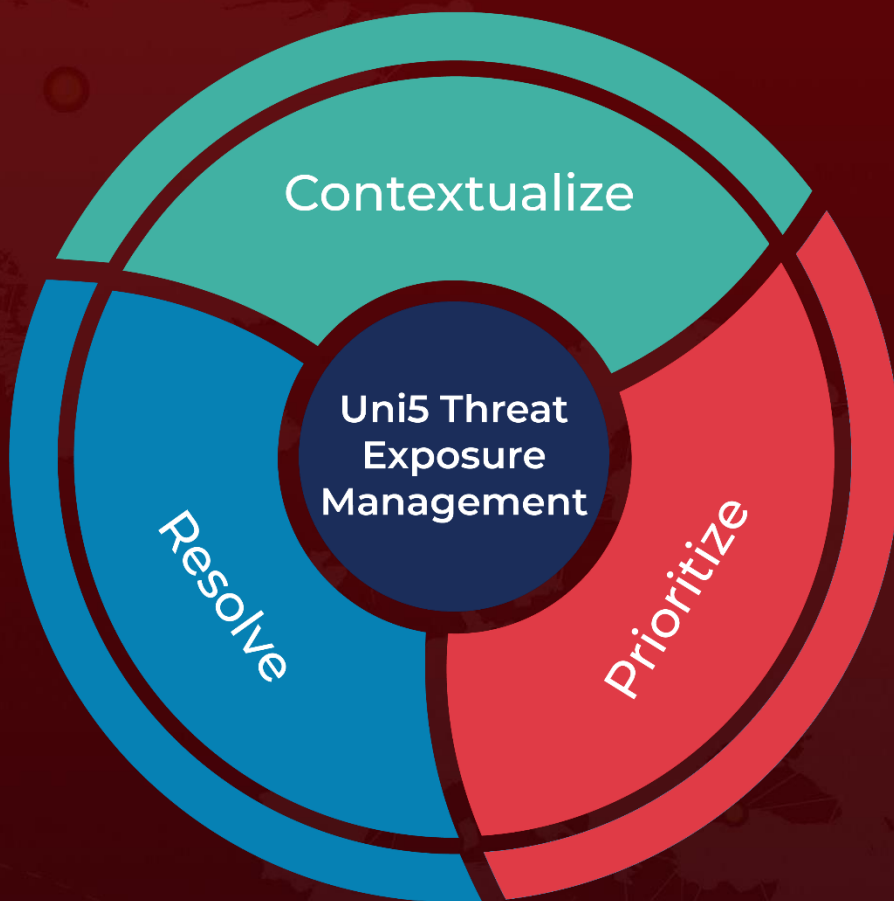
<https://www.zscaler.com/blogs/security-research/apt-36-uses-new-ttps-and-new-tools-target-indian-governmental-organizations>

<https://attack.mitre.org/groups/G0134/>

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